Social Media Marketing

Exploring Instagram in detail

Summary Notes

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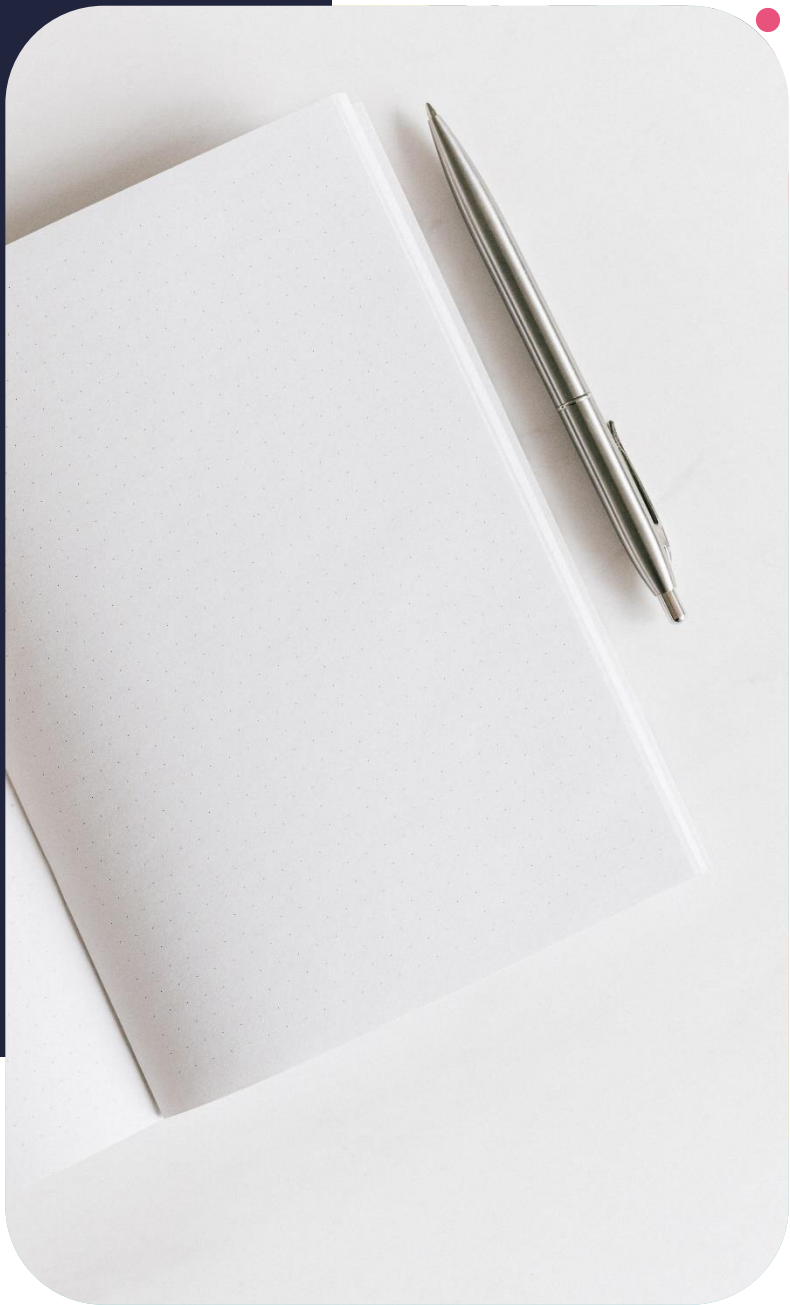

Lesson outcomes

- Instagram posting features
- IGTV and video
- Instagram content creation
- Creative best practices
- Facebook and Instagram

Fun Fact

60% of Instagram users discover new products on the platform.

Instagram posting features

Instagram posting

Log into Instagram account you will start from your newsfeed > here you can immediately post a story – view other stories – scroll through news feed – home button brings you back to home page – search for content using keywords, trends or hashtags – the plus box at the bottom allows you to create a post by immediately opening up your gallery – the heart button allows you to see your promotions and branded content, stories about you and new comments or likes – while the last button opens up your profile.

Need a reminder on how to do this?
Rewatch lesson recording from 01:42 to 02:56.

Instagram Stories

Post a story from your home feed – or from your profile > click on the blue plus > take or upload photo > edit your story – you can add effects to your image – add a link – save the photo to your phone – add a sticker – doodle on the image or – add text – click on your story to post immediately > OR click on close friends to share your story with your close friends > OR send your story as a message.

Need a reminder on how to do this?
Rewatch lesson recording from 02:59 to 06:57.

Fun Fact!
1/3rd of the most viewed stories come from businesses

Stories Content Tips

- Post unfiltered moments such as behind-the-scenes business shots
- Share customer reviews on stories to increase brand awareness and brand trust
- Share products and services to generate interest around new products or services, sales, include a link to landing pages
- Posting product demos and tutorials will reinforce your industry expertise, educate your followers and entice potential customers
- Use hashtags

Instagram photos

Click on create post > upload image from gallery – take a photo directly from app > add a filter – adjust the image - change brightness - contrast - structure - warmth - saturation - colour - fade - highlights - shadows - vignette - tilt shift or sharpen > click next > add your copy or caption > tag people > add a location > share to your Facebook, Twitter or Tumblr > click on advanced settings > turn on commenting and edit accessibility - write alt text for your image > tag a business partner or allow a business partner to promote your content > post

Need a reminder on how to do this?
Rewatch lesson recording from 09:04 to 11:14.

Instagram videos

Click on create post > select the video option > record a video by holding down the centre button > move on to the next step at the top right of the screen > add a filter to your video > add cover image for your video > choose from the video shots > click next > add video copy or caption > tag people > add a location > post to Facebook, Twitter or Tumblr > post

Need a reminder on how to do this?
Rewatch lesson recording from 11:14 to 12:39.

Instagram Photo and Video Tips

- Identify overarching themes to focus on
- Feature colour schemes with campaigns
- Consider the best visual format and type for your message
- Use hashtags

IGTV

Download IGTV separately from your app store.
Click on search button > click on IGTV top left > click on plus button top right to add your own video > choose video to upload > review the video > click next > add a cover > click next > add a title and description > add to a series > allow the post a preview > make it visible on Facebook > click on advanced settings > tag a business partner if relevant > post

Need a reminder on how to do this?
Rewatch lesson recording from 13:28 to 16:19.

IGTV Tips

- Long-form content
- Share a 1 minute preview of your video in your feed
- Create awareness around your IGTV channel
- Share exclusive content to your IGTV channel
- Create a video series
- Use hashtags

Live Streaming

Click on create post > scroll left > click on go live option > when you click on the capture button you will immediately go live. You are able to toggle the camera if you want to present to the audience or you might just want to film – and on the bottom left hand side you can see and respond to questions. When you are live you are able to apply filters – add stickers and to end your live feed – there will be an end button on the tip right hand corner of the screen – Instagram will also give you the option to save your live video and to share it.

Need a reminder on how to do this?
Rewatch lesson recording from 17:51 to 18:39.

Live Video Tips

- Promote your live broadcast
- Pin your video title to the top of your comments
- Include viewers with shoutouts
- Use a format – intro, outro, reminders
- Mute troll comments
- Ask followers to follow you, subscribe to IGTV channel, comment or direct message you
- Save your live video
- Track number of viewers
- Create a post or story afterwards
- Follow up after video

Live video content ideas

- New products
- Behind the scenes
- Guest features
- Q&A sessions
- Surprise and delight

Creating content for Instagram

Instagram content creation

- Engaging, high quality images and videos
- Posting schedule
- Tell a story
- Be relatable
- Instagram features

Instagram content ideas

- Recurring Challenges
- Post photo essays
- Repurpose existing content
- Product teasers
- Collaborate with influencers
- Flash sales
- Competitions
- User generated content

Instagram best practices

- Optimise your profile
- Follow and follow back
- Post quality content
- Use call to actions
- Use hashtags
- Engage with followers
- Make data based decisions

Instagram community guidelines

- Only share content that you have the right to share
- Post content that is appropriate for a diverse audience
- Foster meaningful and genuine interactions
- Follow the law
- Respect other members of the Instagram community
- Maintain a supportive environment
- Be thoughtful when posting newsworthy events

Facebook and Instagram

Facebook	Instagram
Facebook mission is to give people the power to build community and bring the world closer together	Instagram is there to strengthen relationships through shared visual experiences that inspire visible action

Advantages of using both networks

- **Unified management:** manage campaigns efficiently and at scale
- **Expanded inventory:** there are more opportunities to reach your target audience efficiently through both networks
- **Creative portability:** provides you with the flexibility to run shared ad creative across both networks

Connecting networks

Facebook settings > click on Instagram > click on connect account > login to Instagram > automatically link up accounts

Need a reminder on how to do this?
Rewatch lesson recording from 31:44 to 32:32.

Crossposting content on Instagram and Facebook

- Videos from Instagram Stories, IGTV and video posts can be shared to Facebook but a Facebook video cannot be shared to Instagram
- IGTV videos cross posted to Facebook may appear in Watch
- Post new videos to multiple pages at the same time
- Publish a single live stream across multiple pages
- Post old videos from another page

Access Instagram in Facebook Creator Studio

Facebook creator studio > click on Instagram icon top middle right

Please note: you cannot create an Instagram post from creator studio

Content library

View all your posts, you can filter content by all content - video - photo - carousel - stories - IGTV, you can also filter by the post status - between a certain time frame - or search for a specific post. Under posts you can see the visual content, post status, published date, like and comments.

Insights

Activity
The reports only show the last 7 days activity. You can see how many posts you have posted in a week – as well as the interactions taken on your page when users engage with your account through likes, shares, saves, etc.

Website visits – the number of taps on the website in your profile
Profile visits – the number of times your profile was viewed
Calls – the number of taps to call your business
Texts – number of taps to text you
Email – number of taps to email you
Get directions – number of taps to get directions to your business

As well as the number of accounts you have reached – this is the number of unique accounts which have seen your posts which is a really good metric to track as you can get more accurate information about your reach by cutting out any duplicate views. At the bottom of the page you can also track your impressions over the past 7 days which is the estimated number of times your posts have been seen.

Audience
Under audience you can view when your followers are on Instagram by day alone or by day and hour together as well as a breakdown of countries and towns/cities.

Inbox

You can manage your Instagram direct messages and comments from the Inbox in creator studio.

As with your Facebook inbox, you can also mark messages as spam, mark as unread, star messages will make a notification to follow up and then once the customer is satisfied you can move to done in order to keep your inbox clean.